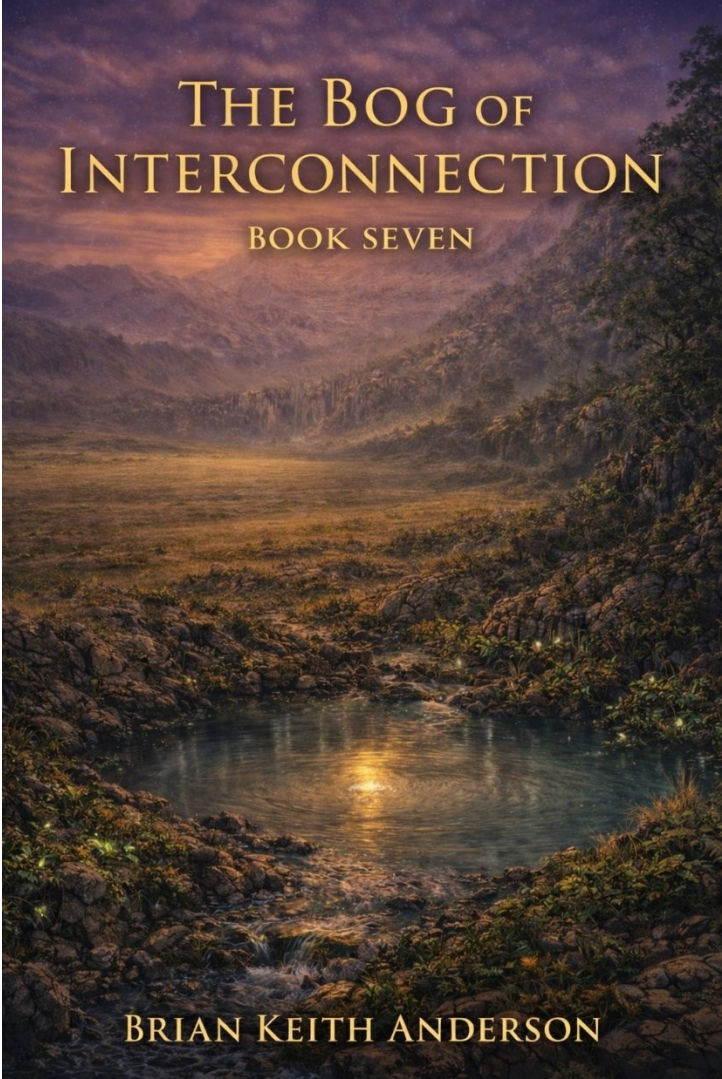




The Bog of Interconnection

Book Seven

of

The Seven Bogs of Mars

by

B. K. Anderson

Copyright Page

Copyright © 2026 by B. K. Anderson

All rights reserved.

No part of this book may be reproduced, stored in a retrieval system, or transmitted in any form or by any means—electronic, mechanical, photocopying, recording, or otherwise—without prior written permission of the author, except for brief quotations used in reviews.

The Seven Bogs of Mars

1. The Bog of Patience: Book Two
2. The Bog of Silence: Book Three
3. The Bog of Movement: Book Four
4. The Bog of Restraint: Book Five
5. The Bog of Passage: Book Six
6. The Bog of Interconnection: Book
Seven
7. The Seventh Heart: Book Eight

Dedication

To those who feel separate
yet know, somewhere within,
that they were never alone.

Epigraph

“Nothing here was ever alone.

It had only forgotten how it was
connected.”

A Quiet Reflection

There comes a moment when the work
changes.

What once required effort...
becomes understanding.

What once seemed broken...
reveals itself as divided.

And what once felt alone...
begins to remember.

Chapter One — The Field That Does Not Separate

The ground held.

The openness of Passage did not follow them.

What had moved freely there did not move here.

Not gone—

only... no longer remembered.

Asa stood a moment longer than he needed to, waiting without knowing he was waiting. After Passage, the stillness felt wrong. Not silent. Not empty.

Simply... unmoving.

He shifted his weight.

Nothing answered.

He took a step.

The surface beneath him accepted it
without change. No softening. No
shaping. No quiet adjustment to his
presence.

He stopped again.

Ahead, Saxifraga had already moved on.
She did not turn. She did not pause. Her
stillness was not hesitation—it was
attention.

Asa followed.

The bog stretched before them in low reaches of dark growth and shallow water. It was not barren. Life lay everywhere, close to the surface, easy to feel.

But it did not carry.

A faint ripple moved across a pool to his left. It reached the far edge—and ended.

No answering motion followed.

He watched it a moment longer.

Then moved on.

The air held a sound he could not at first
place. Not silence. Not quite a hum.
Something between.

He slowed, listening.

It did not gather. It did not deepen. It
remained scattered, as if each part of it
belonged to itself alone.

Asa glanced toward Saxifraga.

She had stopped now, not far ahead,
looking outward.

He came beside her.

For a time, neither spoke.

There was no need.

The wrongness of the place did not rise sharply. It settled slowly, like something almost familiar that refused to take full shape.

He crouched near the edge of a narrow stretch of water. His hand hovered, then lowered.

The surface stirred.

A small ring widened outward—and stilled.

Asa remained there, watching.

It should have gone farther.

He did not say it.

He rose.

Movement caught his eye.

A small form crossed the ground ahead—

low, quick, alive. The growth it left

responded faintly, bending as it passed.

The place it entered did not.

The motion broke.

Asa frowned slightly.

In the other bogs, even stillness had held
relation. Silence had listened. Movement
had carried. Passage had continued.

Here—

nothing moved beyond itself.

“They are here,” Saxifraga said.

Her voice was quiet.

Asa did not turn.

He already knew what she meant.

The sound shifted again—scattered,
uneven.

Then he saw them.

The bees came slowly into view. Not together. One moved past him at shoulder height. Another traced the surface of the water. A third passed low along the ground.

Each followed its own path.

None turned.

None gathered.

None answered the others.

Asa watched them carefully.

This was not how they had been.

Here—

they were many.

But not one.

He stepped forward into their passing.

One moved near him. Another crossed
just beyond.

Neither changed course.

Neither altered.

Asa stopped.

The faint sound filled the space again.

Not broken. Not damaged.

Only—

unshared.

He looked toward Saxifraga.

“They are not lost.”

“No.”

“They are not broken.”

“No.”

He hesitated.

“Then why—”

She turned then, meeting his gaze.

“They do not yet remember.”

Asa let that settle.

He looked back at the bees.

Still moving.

Still alive.

Still separate.

He closed his eyes for a moment. Not
searching. Only listening.

The sound remained—faint, uneven,
present.

When he opened his eyes, nothing had
changed.

The bees continued.

The water held.

The ground remained.

He stepped forward again.

Not to guide.

Not to gather.

Not to fix.

Only to enter.

The bog did not answer.

But something in the space between the
movements—

waited.

“Thank you for reading my sample”